ACS Year II, sem.1
COURSE: CTLS
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SEMINAR 5: ORAL PRESENTATIONS – STRUCTURE AND VOICE

I. STRUCTURING AN ORAL PRESENTATION

1) https://virtualspeech.com/blog/how-to-structure-your-presentation

2) Alex Lyon - Bad ways to start a presentation
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lxotDKJPZIs

3) Alex Lyon - Opening and closing strategies
https://youtu.be/8IbR8Y09dx4

4) Presentational aids
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZC4q6lykPUQ

II. THE ROLE OF VOICE IN ORAL PRESENTATIONS

We speak with an instrument we call "the voice". Listen to the sounds people make when they speak – only the sounds – and you will discover something of the person playing the instrument. I learned that the spaces between words were as important as the words themselves. A word could be emphasized and a thought underlined by silence, by space, whilst the rapid, close, unbroken delivery of words causes the ideas to become blurred and recede into noise. The voice reveals who we are and how we are more than the words we choose. And the feelings communicated in the sounds of words are the only truth. (excerpt from Gerry Spence, *How to Argue and Win Every Time*, 1995, in *In Company Upper-Intermediate,* p. 23)

Gerry Spence is a renowned American lawyer who, in a TV mock trial organized in the UK in 1986 defended Lee Harvey Oswald, the assassin of J. F. Kennedy, against Vincent Bugliosi, the prosecutor. In his book *How to Argue and Win Every Time* (1995), Spence, who, in a career spanning over 50 years, has never lost a criminal case, views the human voice as a musical instrument which needs to be tuned to the feelings and attitude of the speaker. Moreover, Spence argues that silence can have a decisive role in persuading people if it is used appropriately.

1. Alex Lyon on how to change tone of voice https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pH287zxVXE0

2. Brian Tracy on voice https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uOVlEIR4rBU

3. TEDx Vocal branding https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p_ylzGfHKOs

4. Utter the sentence "*I've been working here for five years*." in such a way as to convey *anger*, *joy*, *sadness* and *contempt*. Make use of voice inflections and facial expressions to sound as credible as possible. Using your mobile phone, record yourselves saying this sentence in different ways and then listen to how your voice sounds. What is your impression?